

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Making Cities Feel Quieter

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Around _____ people worldwide live in cities and are exposed to urban sound environments.
2	Examples of city noise include rattling _____, car horns and planes overhead.
3	By 2050, about 2.5 billion people may experience _____.
4	Loud noise exposure has also been connected with _____.
5	In Mumbai, daytime noise often reaches _____.
6	After years abroad, Chhavi says the thing she misses is _____.
7	Living overseas made her used to _____ of noise.
8	Soundscaping adds selected sounds to _____.
9	The Montreal project used holiday sounds such as _____.
10	The key idea is that a park can feel less noisy by adding _____.

11 **What does the opening sound experiment show?**

- A People can ignore most sounds in cities.
- B Relaxing sounds are always louder than stressful ones.
- C City residents prefer traffic noise to natural sounds.
- D The surrounding sound environment can strongly affect us.

12 **Which set of urban noises is mentioned?**

- A Trains, car horns and aircraft.
- B Factories, dogs and construction tools.
- C Music, school bells and crowds.
- D Rain, wind and emergency sirens.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What health-related concern is linked to noise exposure?**
- A It has been shown to improve concentration.
 - B It prevents all forms of hearing damage.
 - C It is associated with hearing loss, stress and anxiety.
 - D It only affects people who travel by plane.
- 14 **How does daytime noise in Mumbai compare with WHO recommendations?**
- A It is slightly below the recommended level.
 - B It is more than 20 decibels above the recommended level.
 - C It matches the recommended level exactly.
 - D It is too low to be measured reliably.
- 15 **How does Chhavi's experience abroad change her reaction to India's noise?**
- A It makes her enjoy louder celebrations more.
 - B It leads her to forget what Indian cities sound like.
 - C It convinces her that noise is never a serious issue.
 - D It makes the noise harder for her to cope with after returning.
- 16 **What is the basic idea of soundscaping?**
- A Removing every sound from a public area.
 - B Adding chosen sounds to make public places feel calmer.
 - C Increasing traffic noise so people stop noticing it.
 - D Replacing parks with indoor listening rooms.
- 17 **Why are the Magdalen Islands mentioned?**
- A They provided sounds that inspired the Montreal park project.
 - B They are noisier than Mumbai during the day.
 - C They are where the WHO measures city noise.
 - D They proved that sand can remove traffic completely.
- 18 **How was the sound installation physically set up in the park?**
- A With headphones handed to every visitor.
 - B With screens placed beside the roads.
 - C With speakers planted in flower beds.
 - D With musicians performing near the sand.

19 **Why is Charles's idea described as counterintuitive?**

- A It tries to make a park seem quieter by adding sound.
- B It depends on making every sound much louder.
- C It works by banning people from public parks.
- D It assumes city noise has no effect on people.

20 **What does the mention of Tokyo and Barcelona imply?**

- A Soundscaping only works in Canadian parks.
- B Similar approaches are being used beyond the Montreal example.
- C Mumbai has already become quieter than European cities.
- D City dwellers no longer need quiet public spaces.